Summer option 4

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Sticky gochujang tofu (mild)
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Soba noodle salad
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Tofu stir fry
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Breakfast:** Egg muffins **Snack:** Granola bars
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Polish potato salad for lunch and Kopytka (potato dumplings) with mizeria for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Sticky gochujang tofu (mild)** **HIM** 4 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 713 kcal, 51 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 571 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2203 kcal**, 144 g **HER 1803 kcal**, 92 g
Wed	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Sticky gochujang tofu (mild)** **HIM** 4 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 713 kcal, 51 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 571 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Soba noodle salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 518 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg + edamame 100 g 463 kcal, 25 g	**HIM 2113 kcal**, 154 g **HER 1796 kcal**, 93 g
Thu, Fri	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Soba noodle salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 518 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg + edamame 100 g 463 kcal, 25 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM 1992 kcal**, 132 g **HER 1669 kcal**, 88 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings) with mizeria** **HIM** 4 parts + 3/4 serving mizeria + 100 g diced chicken 730 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 serving mizeria + cottage cheese 125 g 549 kcal, 27 g	**HIM 2315 kcal**, 154 g **HER 1792 kcal**, 92 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings) with mizeria** **HIM** 4 parts + 3/4 serving mizeria + 100 g diced chicken 730 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 serving mizeria + cottage cheese 125 g 549 kcal, 27 g	**HIM 2315 kcal**, 154 g **HER 1792 kcal**, 92 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with sticky gochujang tofu (mild) (about 40 min). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (6 servings).
2. Then egg muffins (about 40 min). Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins).
3. Then granola bars (25 min of work plus 2 hours chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars).
4. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
5. Cook brown rice for the lunch boxes: 4.5 cups cooked (290 g dry).
6. Hard-boil 3 eggs.
7. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Soba noodle salad is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Cook soba noodle salad (about 15 min). Eat it for dinner and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.
Thursday	Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make Polish potato salad (about 30 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) and the mizeria (about 40 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $225.58 for both of you for the seven days ($112.79 each). Buying every pack new costs about $363.36 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Summer option 4

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart, not priced

Gochujang (Korean chili paste); Dried soba noodles, 600 g. Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: garlic powder, peanuts, red pepper flakes, sesame seeds, dried basil, oregano, vanilla, cinnamon, sunflower seeds, coconut flakes, chili paste (sambal oelek), dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), apple cider vinegar.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	8	8 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$7.28
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	343 g	3 x 142 g	$4.99	$12.05
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Carrots	180 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$0.63
☐ Cilantro	1.5 bunch	2 x bunch	$2.49	$3.74
☐ Fresh dill	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$3.99	$3.99
☐ Fresh ginger	15 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.10
☐ Garlic	0.7 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.30
☐ Grape tomatoes	220 g	1 x 284 g	$3.99	$3.09
☐ Green bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.11	$2.11
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	2.85 bunch	3 x bunch	$2.49	$7.10
☐ Long English cucumber	3	3 x each	$2.99	$8.97
☐ Radishes	0.5 bunch	1 x bunch	$2.99	$1.50
☐ Red bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.98	$2.98
☐ White mushrooms, loose	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$1.52
☐ Yellow onions	205 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$0.75
☐ Yellow potatoes	2.5 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$3.85
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	2.25 kg	3 x 750 g	$8.25	$24.75
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	5.37 block	6 x 350 g	$3.99	$21.43
☐ Feta (Tre Stelle)	76 g	1 x 375 g	$8.99	$1.82
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	1.23 kg	1 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$8.60
☐ Large white eggs	42	3 x 18	$7.45	$17.38
☐ Plain yogurt 3.5% (Olympic)	350 g	1 x 650 g	$6.79	$3.66
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	87 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$1.28
☐ Sour cream 14% (Dairyland)	250 mL	1 x 500 mL	$4.85	$2.42
Grains & bakery				
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	270 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.35
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	585 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$2.57
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	21 slice	2 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$6.98
☐ Whole grain spaghetti (Catelli), stand-in for soba	600 g	2 x 375 g	$4.29	$6.86
Pantry & cans				
☐ Canned peas (Western Family)	1 can	1 x 398 mL can	$2.59	$2.59
☐ Dijon mustard (Western Family)	5 mL	1 x 325 mL	$3.99	$0.06
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	15 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$0.24
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	486 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$7.19
☐ Mayonnaise (Western Family)	45 mL	1 x 890 mL	$6.99	$0.35
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	90 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$2.26
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	176 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.05
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	202 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$4.03
☐ Polskie ogorki dill pickles (Bick's)	4 pickles	1 x 1 L jar, about 12 pickles	$6.99	$2.33
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	235 mL	2 x 185 mL	$3.99	$5.07
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	270 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$2.09
Frozen				
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	600 g	2 x 500 g	$2.99	$3.59
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$225.58**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$363.36**

Cook and split: Summer option 4

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Sticky gochujang tofu (mild) SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (6 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: pinchofyum.com/sticky-gochujang-tofu-with-herbs-and-peanuts (Pinch of Yum)

BUY FOR IT	1.95 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 48 g natural smooth peanut butter; 0.75 long english cucumber; 0.45 bunch green onions. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toss tofu chunks with oil, cornstarch, salt and pepper; bake at 400 F for 25 min, turning once. 2. Shake gochujang, sesame oil, soy, peanut butter and garlic powder in a jar. 3. Toss the hot tofu in the sauce. 4. Serve over rice with cucumber, herbs and peanuts.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 3/4 cup brown rice. Her: 3/4 cup brown rice, edamame 100 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge.
REHEAT	Microwave 60 to 90 s, or eat cold over rice with cucumber.
ALLERGENS	Soy, peanuts, sesame (gochujang can contain wheat)
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	Spicy as written. Use 1 tbsp gochujang instead of 3 in the sauce, toss her tofu first, then add the rest of the gochujang to his.
NOTE	The page says 3 to 4 servings; I use its nutrition figure as 1 of 4. This plan makes 1 1/2 times the recipe.

Egg muffins SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-breakfast-egg-muffins (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	60 g baby spinach; 1 red bell pepper; 1 green bell pepper; 220 g grape tomatoes; 20 large white eggs; 76 g feta. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Divide spinach, peppers and tomatoes among greased muffin cups. 2. Whisk eggs, whites and seasoning; pour over and top with feta. 3. Bake at 350 F about 25 min.
SPLIT	Each weekday: 2 muffins for him, 2 muffins for her. 4 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: 2 slices sourdough, Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple.
KEEP	3 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author). Freeze Thursday's and Friday's.
REHEAT	Microwave 30 to 45 s from the fridge, about 60 s from frozen.
ALLERGENS	Eggs, milk (feta)
NOTE	The tomatoes are baked in. To keep his completely tomato-free, leave them out of half the cups.

Granola bars SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars) · about 135 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-granola-bars (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	270 g large flake oats; 202 g natural whole almonds, bulk bin; 255 g liquid honey; 128 g natural smooth peanut butter; 90 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toast oats, nuts and seeds. 2. Warm honey with peanut butter, stir in vanilla, cinnamon and the toasted mix; fold in chips. 3. Press firmly into a lined pan, chill 2 hours, cut into 10.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 1 bar for him, 1 bar for her. 1 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: cottage cheese 125 g. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	1 week at room temperature, 2 weeks in the fridge, 2 months frozen (author).
REHEAT	Eat as is.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts, tree nuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy

Tofu stir fry MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.
KEEP	Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).
REHEAT	Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
HEAT	Leave the chili paste out of the pan; he adds it at the table.
NOTE	Meatless.

Soba noodle salad WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make 3 x the recipe (6 servings) · about 15 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/soba-salad (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT	600 g whole grain spaghetti, stand-in for soba; 135 mL pure sesame oil; 189 g liquid honey; 135 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.9 bunch green onions; 1.5 bunch cilantro. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Warm the oils with chili flakes for 3 min, then whisk in honey and soy. 2. Boil the soba, rinse well under cold water and drain. 3. Toss noodles with the dressing, scallions, cilantro and sesame seeds.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: 1 boiled egg, edamame 100 g.
KEEP	Up to 3 days in an airtight container (author).
REHEAT	Eat cold.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soba and soy sauce), sesame
H MART	Dried soba noodles, 600 g
HEAT	Leave out the optional chili flakes, or use a pinch; he adds chili oil to his.
NOTE	The recipe serves 2, so this plan triples it. Costed with spaghetti as a stand-in because Save-On lists no soba; buy the real thing at H Mart.

Vegetarian bibimbap THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	The gochujang sauce goes on top, not in the dish: a small dab for her, a full spoon for him.
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Polish potato salad SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-potato-salad (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 1.5 kg yellow potatoes; 5 large white eggs; 150 g yellow onions; 4 pickles polskie ogorki dill pickles; 1 can canned peas; 1 ambrosia apple; 45 mL mayonnaise; 5 mL dijon mustard; 0.5 bunch fresh dill. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Boil the potatoes and the eggs; cool and cube both. 2. Chop the pickles and onion finely; cube the apple. 3. Fold everything with the drained peas, mayonnaise, mustard and plenty of dill.

SPLIT Set 2 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.

SIDES Him: nothing extra. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.

KEEP The page only says to keep it refrigerated. My guidance: 3 days.

REHEAT Eat cold.

ALLERGENS Eggs, mustard

NOTE Polish salatka with apple and peas. Costed with Bick's Polskie ogorki; a Polish deli's kiszone are closer to what the author means.

Kopytka (potato dumplings) SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.

SPLIT Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.

SIDES Him: 3/4 serving mizeria, 100 g diced chicken. Her: 3/4 serving mizeria, cottage cheese 125 g.

KEEP The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.

REHEAT Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.

ALLERGENS Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)

NOTE You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.

Mizeria SATURDAY EVENING

Side for the kopytka · make half the recipe (3 servings) · full recipe: polonist.com/mizeria-polish-cucumber-salad (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 2.25 long english cucumber; 0.5 bunch radishes; 55 g yellow onions; 350 g plain yogurt 3.5%; 250 mL sour cream 14%; 0.5 bunch fresh dill.

OUTLINE 1. Slice cucumbers (and radishes) thin, salt them and let them drain. 2. Stir strained yogurt and sour cream with vinegar, dill and pepper. 3. Fold the cucumbers into the dressing and chill.

SPLIT 3/4 serving each, each night.

KEEP Up to 2 days in the fridge; do not freeze (author).

ALLERGENS Milk

NOTE This plan makes half the recipe. The long time on the page is draining and chilling, not work.